

GUIDELINE DOCUMENT — FOR ADOPTION

HALL OF WORSHIP
DESIGN STANDARDS

DOCUMENT NO. GMF-DS-001	VERSION 1.0 — Draft for adoption	DATE 05 July 2026
APPLIES TO Design of all new Halls of Worship and modifications to existing halls	STATUS Mandatory once adopted	PREPARED BY Vollmann Akarakiri

01. PURPOSE

Across multiple hall projects the same design elements have been built differently — and sometimes wrongly — because no document fixed their standard: the altar area and its steps, ceiling heights, the curved altar wall, seating, the fore hall, and the finishes used in each location. The Osogbo remodification (RPT-2026-OSG-001) is the direct cost of that gap. This standard fixes **one set of design parameters for every Hall of Worship**, so that every new hall is designed from these values and every renovation is corrected toward them.

This document works together with GMF-PG-001 (project phases), GMF-BIM-001 (the parameters below are built into every BIM model and template) and GMF-QS-001 (hold point 1 — setting-out — verifies them on site).

02. HOW TO USE THIS STANDARD

1. Each section defines the rule and, where applicable, a **standard value**. Values marked **[TBR]** — *to be ratified* — are spiritual or Foundation-level decisions: they must be confirmed by leadership, measured from the designated **reference hall**, entered here, and the document reissued as v1.1.
2. Values not marked [TBR] are proposed from the National Building Code and good practice, and apply unless leadership amends them at adoption.
3. **No deviation without approval.** Any departure from a ratified value on any project requires Project Board approval through the change-order procedure (GMF-CM-001 §6) before execution — never a site decision.
4. All geometry in this standard is defined in the project BIM model and set out from the survey benchmarks — **never set out by eye on site.**

03. ALTAR AREA

The altar area is the element most frequently built wrong. All of its geometry is governed by the **altar centreline** — the axis running from the centre of the altar wall through the middle of the hall — and every dimension below is set out from it.

Parameter	Rule	Standard value
Number of altar steps	Identical in every hall; full width of the altar opening; no winders or part-steps.	[TBR]
Step dimensions	All risers equal within ± 5 mm; riser 150–170 mm; tread ≥ 300 mm; nosing flush, non-slip finish.	riser [TBR] tread [TBR]
Step plan form & radius	Where steps are curved, the radius is struck from the defined centre point on the altar centreline; the same setting-out point is used for every curved element in the altar zone.	$R = \text{[TBR]}$
Curved altar wall radius	Struck from the same centre point as the steps, so wall and steps are concentric with the altar. Radius fixed relative to altar depth.	$R = \text{[TBR]}$

Altar size	Altar platform depth × width fixed relative to hall width; the altar itself (table) to the standard dimensions of the reference hall.	platform [TBR] altar [TBR]
Reading desk	Standard size, top height, slope and position (offset from the altar centreline and setback from the front step edge) identical in all halls; detail drawing kept in the template library (GMF-BIM-001 §8).	[TBR]
Altar gate	Width, height, material and position on the step line per the reference detail; opening direction away from the congregation.	[TBR]
Cross location (internal)	Centred on the altar centreline on the altar wall; mounting height fixed above altar level; concealed fixing.	height [TBR]

Site rule: the altar zone is set out and checked at hold point 1 (GMF-QS-001 §4) against the BIM model before any foundation or step is cast. The Osogbo case — altar 3.00 m built against 3.45 m designed — is exactly what this check exists to prevent.

04. CEILING

Parameter	Rule	Standard value
Main hall clear height	Finished floor to finished ceiling; generous enough for dignity, ventilation and acoustics.	min. 3.6 m (proposed)
Altar section ceiling	Raised above the main hall ceiling over the full altar zone, stepped at the altar opening line.	+600 mm (proposed, [TBR])
Fore hall ceiling	Equal to or lower than the main hall ceiling — never higher.	= main hall (proposed)
Build-up	Plasterboard on stud and track (or equal approved), flush jointed; access panels located outside the altar zone; no exposed services below ceiling level in the worship space.	10 mm board

05. FORE HALL

Parameter	Rule	Standard value
Provision	Every hall has a fore hall between the entrance and the main hall — worshippers never enter the main hall directly from outside.	mandatory
Ratio to main hall	Fore hall floor area as a proportion of main hall area, constant across capacities.	1 : 5 (proposed, [TBR])
Separation	Full-height partition to the ceiling with doors on the centreline axis; doors silent-closing; partition acoustically sealed.	full height

06. CAPACITY, SEATING AND HALL SIZE

Parameter	Rule	Standard value
Participants-to-area ratio	Net seating area of the main hall per seated participant (excludes altar zone, aisles and fore hall). Hall size derives from confirmed congregation + growth allowance (GMF-PG-001 Phase 1), never the reverse.	0.65 m ² /person (proposed)
Row spacing	Seat back to seat back, constant through the hall.	950 mm (proposed)
Aisles	Central aisle on the altar centreline; side aisles at the walls. No seat more than 6 seats from an aisle.	centre ≥ 1200 mm side ≥ 900 mm
Front row to altar steps	Clear distance from front seat edge to the first altar step, constant across halls.	[TBR]
Arrangement	Seating symmetrical about the altar centreline; rows parallel to the altar wall; any Foundation seating convention (e.g. sides) recorded here at ratification.	[TBR]

07. ADJOINED BUILDINGS AND ROOMS

Item	Rule
Allowed adjoining spaces	Ante-room and flower room (flanking the altar), fore hall, conveniences, cloakroom, and administration/reception — subject to the ratified list [TBR] . No residential, commercial or kitchen space may adjoin the worship hall directly.
Entry requirements	Ancillary spaces never open directly into the main hall except the ante-room and flower room doors serving the altar, and the fore hall doors. Conveniences are reached from outside the worship space, never through the main hall, and are never placed against the altar wall.
Acoustic separation	Walls between the main hall and any occupied ancillary space are full-height and acoustically sealed; generator and pump rooms are detached or remote from the hall.

08. EXTERNAL CROSS

Parameter	Rule	Standard value
Location	Position on the site or principal elevation per the ratified Foundation convention; aligned with the building's main axis; visible from the principal approach.	[TBR]
Size & proportion	Standard proportion and dimensions from the reference detail in the template library.	[TBR]
Construction	Corrosion-resistant material and fixings; structurally designed for wind where freestanding or roof-mounted; discreet lighting where illuminated.	per detail

09. MATERIALS BY LOCATION

One material standard per location, applied in every hall, so quality and appearance are consistent nationwide. Samples are approved and retained per GMF-QS-001 §5.

Location	Standard material / finish	Value
Altar platform floor	Finish per the ratified reference (dignified, non-slip, matt).	[TBR]
Altar wall (curved wall)	Smooth plasterboard or rendered finish, uniform colour per the reference palette; no glossy or reflective surfaces.	[TBR]
Main hall floor	Hard-wearing, low-noise, matt finish (e.g. honed tile or screed with approved covering) — uniform in colour across the hall.	[TBR]
Main hall walls	Rendered and painted in the standard palette; no untreated blockwork in the worship space.	palette [TBR]
Ceilings	Plasterboard per §04, painted matt white or per palette.	palette [TBR]
Fore hall	Same floor family as the main hall; walls per palette.	palette [TBR]
Doors & windows	Standard profiles and finishes from the template library; silent hardware in the worship space.	per detail
External walls & roof	SON-compliant materials per GMF-QS-001 §5; roof colour and wall colour per the ratified external palette.	palette [TBR]

10. RUGS AND CARPETS

Parameter	Rule	Standard value
Altar rug	Standard colour, material and quality grade for the altar platform; sized to the platform with even margins; edges fixed, no curling or loose edges.	[TBR]
Centre aisle rug	Runs the centre aisle from the fore hall doors to the altar steps on the centreline; same colour family as the altar rug; width co-ordinated with the aisle.	[TBR]

Procurement	Approved supplier/sample retained (GMF-QS-001 §5); replacement like-for-like so halls do not drift apart over time.	—
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11. HALLS IN STOREY BUILDINGS

Where a Hall of Worship forms part of a multi-storey building, the following apply in addition to all sections above:

- 1. Permission:** a hall in a storey building requires explicit Board approval at Gate 1, with the justification recorded (typically urban land constraints).
- 2. Placement:** the worship hall occupies the topmost floor of its wing unless leadership ratifies otherwise — no occupied rooms, sanitary spaces or water tanks directly above the worship space, and never above the altar zone **[TBR]**.
- 3. Full standard applies:** the altar geometry (§03), ceiling heights (§04) and fore hall (§05) apply unchanged — the structural grid and floor-to-floor height must be designed around the hall, not the hall squeezed into a standard floor.
- 4. Structure & vibration:** long-span structure over the hall (no columns within the worship space); floor design checked for vibration and acoustic transmission from other floors.
- 5. Access & egress:** stair widths and travel distances sized for the full hall capacity per the National Building Code; level access or lift provision for elderly and disabled worshippers.
- 6. Services:** no water or drainage pipework routed above the worship space; other occupancies in the building acoustically isolated from the hall.

12. RATIFICATION AND DEVIATION

- Leadership designates the **reference hall**; all [TBR] values are measured/decided from it, entered into this document and into the BIM template library, and the standard is reissued as v1.1.
- From v1.1 the values are binding on every project. A deviation on a specific project requires Board approval by change order (GMF-CM-001 §6) **before** execution, recorded in this document's project file.
- Existing halls are assessed against this standard when their as-built BIM models are produced (GMF-HR-001 §4); differences are logged and corrected when renovation works are undertaken.

13. REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Change	Author
1.0	05 July 2026	First issue for adoption — [TBR] values pending ratification	Vollmann Akarakiri

AUTHORISATION

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